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Date: Tuesday 26 August 2025 at 15:13
Subject: Waterproofing

Subject: 1 Riverside Cottages – Why both MacLennan systems are vital reinstatement, not betterment

Hi Andy,

I want to set out clearly why the MacLennan quotation for both the cavity drain membrane and cementitious system must be authorised by insurers as essential reinstatement works rather than treated as betterment.

1. MacLennan's professional recommendation

MacLennan have surveyed the property and advised that the most suitable approach in this case is a dual-system installation – the cavity drain membrane (CDM) together with a cementitious coating. This is described as the most robust method to reinstate a building subjected to groundwater pressure of the type we've now proven on site .

2. Groundwater evidence

Both the internal and external sumps filled immediately when cut, confirming high groundwater and direct river influence. Reinstate without a dual system and there is a very high probability of repeat ingress and failure.

3. Why both systems are needed

The cementitious coating provides a physical barrier. But on its own, it is subject to movement cracking, hydrostatic stress, and limited guarantees .

The cavity drain membrane provides a serviceable, maintainable system under BS 8102:2022, collecting any penetrating water and safely removing it via sump pumps .

Together they provide the "belt and braces" solution — one system resists ingress, the other manages any residual water. This is what MacLennan deem necessary in this environment.

4. Guarantees and compliance

The dual system is the only way to achieve a meaningful, insurance-backed guarantee. CDM alone is the only system that can be serviced and maintained to prevent leaks before they occur .

Cementitious alone is not recommended without structural verification, and carries multiple exclusions.

By following MacLennan's specification for both, we meet BS 8102, secure valid guarantees, and reinstate the property to an insurable standard.

5. Not betterment, but necessary reinstatement

The works are not a luxury upgrade — they are the minimum professional recommendation to restore the building to a dry, habitable condition in its riverside context.

Reinstating with finishes only, or with a single system against advice, would knowingly recreate the conditions for failure. That cannot be called reinstatement.

Conclusion

Given the proven hydrostatic conditions, MacLennan's dual-system specification is vital for reinstatement, not betterment. It ensures compliance with BS 8102, secures valid guarantees, and restores the property to a serviceable, durable, and insurable state.

I would therefore ask that insurers accept and authorise the full MacLennan quotation as necessary reinstatement.

Finally, I am attaching two photographs taken today showing just how high the water table is. Approximately 8" below ground zero. In winter as we know it could rise by up to 4 feet especially as we are only 20 yards from the river.

I have copied in this email to Simon Riches at Maclennans.

I am also enclosing their quotation.

If you and or insurers require any further information please don't hesitate to let Simon know.

Many thanks.

Nicholas

Nicholas Scarr

Sent from my iPhone

Attachments (3):

- image0.jpeg (174,845 bytes)

- image1.jpeg (140,066 bytes)
- 1 Riverside Cottages, The Dean REVIII Quote 30114.pdf (1,126,541 bytes)